Performance Standards Overview	Number	Page
	20.01	1 of 2

Effective Date:
May 1, 2025

Background:
To ensure counties comply with state and federal Medi-Cal regulations, the Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) monitors data using the California Statewide Automated Welfare System (CalSAWS) and the Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS). Additionally, DHCS conducts focused reviews to evaluate whether counties are accurately determining Medi-Cal eligibility.

Purpose:
The purpose of this revision is to reintroduce performance standards policies. References to county self-certification have been removed. Medi-Cal Program Guide (MPG) 20.02 Eligibility and Redeterminations has been incorporated into this section.

Policy:
Effective June 1, 2024, DHCS lifted the hold harmless policy and transitioned to data driven monitoring of performance standards. County Performance Standards (CPS) measure the timeliness of county actions using data from CalSAWS and MEDS.

Timeliness and Performance Standards
Timeliness is measured at the individual level. If eligibility can be established and approved for any family member, approval must not be delayed.

The components for CPS and required percentage of timeliness are listed below.

Performance Standard	Components	Percentage
Initial Eligibility Determination Processing (applications and requests to add an additional household member)	• Regular applications that are received complete must be processed within 45 days of application. • Applications based on disability must be processed within 90 days of application, excluding when delayed by the state.	90%
Annual Renewal (RE) Processing	RE packets returned to the county timely **and** complete must be processed within 60 days starting from the last day of the annual RE month.	90%
MEDS Alerts Processing	Timely processing of critical MEDS alerts: • Reconciliation alerts. • Non-reconciliation/worker alerts.	95% 90%

Definitions
For the purpose of CPS:

- "Complete" means that the county has the information necessary to conduct an ex parte review and make an eligibility determination (for example, necessary questions on the application or RE form were answered, necessary verifications were provided, and no further information is required from the customer).

- "Timely" for RE means that the RE form is received by the last date of the RE due month.
- For the definition of "timely" as it pertains to MEDS Alerts, refer to MPG 20.03 MEDS Alerts.

Note: The processing time of applications and RE's can be extended if unusual circumstances occur. Circumstances may include delays caused by the customer, Authorized Representative (AR), State Programs - Disability Determination Services Division (SP-DDSD), examining physician, or other administrative or emergency factors beyond control of the county.

Focused Review Process

Focused reviews evaluate the accuracy and timeliness of applications, RE's, or MEDS alert processing actions taken by the county. DHCS will select counties for a review on a quarterly basis. Counties will have a focused review at least once every two years regardless of performance.

Corrective Action Plan (CAP)

When a focused review indicates the county is not meeting CPS, the county may be required to develop a CAP to address areas that may be contributing to non-compliance of CPS.

Procedure:

Refer to Application and Renewal Performance Standards Tracking Processing Guide.
Guides for resolving DHCS monitored MEDS alerts can be found in Eligibility Essentials.

Program Impacts:

None

References:

ACWDL No. 23-14E, 24-17
MEDIL I No. 23-43, 24-12
MEPM Article 25

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance by April 30, 2028.

Approval for Release:

5-15-25

Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services